

MATTHEW O'LEARY

Production Designer & Manager Santa Cruz, CA | 831-275-2566 | matt@mattoleary.design | mattoleary.design | linkedin.com/in/matt-oleary

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Production Designer & Manager with 20+ years of experience across magazine publishing, CPG packaging, and large-scale print production. Skilled in the full Adobe Creative Suite (InDesign, Photoshop, Illustrator, Acrobat Pro), prepress workflows, and vendor/print management, with a growing focus on leveraging AI and generative tools to automate production tasks, accelerate proofing cycles, and scale output without sacrificing quality. Experienced in multi-SKU retail rollouts, dielines, and color separations, with a strong track record of on-time, on-spec delivery.

CORE SKILLS

Publishing & Editorial: Magazine & Custom Publication Design, Page Mapping & Imposition, Book Interior & Cover Systems, Typography, Layout Systems & Visual Hierarchy, Proofing & Stakeholder Approval Cycles

Production & Vendor Management: Printer & Vendor Relationship Management, Press Checks & Quality Control, Preflight (PDF/X-1a), Print Order & Paper Specification Coordination, Prepress Workflow Management, Color Management (CMYK, Spot/Pantone)

Packaging & Collateral: CPG Packaging Design, Rigid & Flexible Dieline Management, Color Separations, FDA-Compliant Copy Placement, Branded Collateral, Multi-SKU Retail Rollouts

Adobe Creative Suite: InDesign, Photoshop, Illustrator, Acrobat Pro – advanced production, layout, and prepress file-building

AI-Enhanced Design & Automation: Generative AI tools (Adobe Firefly, Midjourney) for concept and asset generation; AI writing/proofing assistants (ChatGPT, Claude) for copy support and QA; workflow automation to reduce manual production steps and speed up turnaround on high-volume projects

Project & Workflow Tools: Airtable, Trello, Asset Management Systems, Digital Delivery Pipelines

Workflow: Independent Project Execution, Cross-Functional Collaboration, High-Volume Output, Fast-Turnaround Delivery

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

California Magazine (Cal Alumni Association) – Designer & Production Manager
Remote (Contract) | Aug 2026 - Present

Lead layout design, image placement, and asset production for California magazine,

maintaining visual and typographic consistency across editorial pages, ads, and custom inserts using Adobe InDesign, Photoshop, and Illustrator. Manage the relationship with the print vendor (Quad), overseeing the workflow from press-ready file delivery through final proof approval. Route layouts and proofs through the Design Director and editorial approval cycles, coordinating revisions under publishing deadlines. Produce post-print digital and web-optimized promotional assets to support cross-channel marketing, using AI-assisted tools to speed up asset variations and turnaround.

Matt O'Leary Design – Freelance Graphic Designer & Production Consultant
Santa Cruz, CA | 2010 - Present

Design and execute press-ready and digital assets for client accounts, managing projects independently from initial creative brief through final production delivery using the Adobe Creative Suite. Develop FDA-compliant packaging mechanicals and layout systems in line with manufacturing requirements. Coordinate with external printers and fabrication vendors on quality control, material specs, and final delivery, tracking project timelines in Trello. Incorporate AI-powered tools into production workflows to automate repetitive tasks and improve file-prep efficiency.

OBXtek – Production Support Specialist
Monterey, CA | Dec 2024 - Oct 2025

Managed visual layout and asset production for learning modules within a government contract at the Defense Language Institute (DLI), using InDesign, Photoshop, and Illustrator. Standardized curriculum graphics and media assets for consistency across 14+ language pipelines, coordinating deliverables and deadlines in Airtable.

Wiser Solutions – Senior Designer
Remote | Apr 2022 - Mar 2023

Managed production assets and design-system consistency across a suite of digital applications, following corporate brand guidelines and template structures. Collaborated with remote teams to streamline asset handoffs and reduce file errors.

Axway – Senior Designer
Remote | Mar 2018 - Apr 2022

Designed and built branded layouts across global web properties and physical/digital marketing campaigns. Standardized corporate visual output through template-driven design systems, improving team asset delivery times.

Kiteworks – Product Designer
Palo Alto, CA | Aug 2014 - Feb 2018

Oversaw production-ready asset delivery for a core enterprise web platform, working closely with engineering. Maintained design-system parameters to keep assets consistent with functional and typographic standards.

FastPencil – Creative Lead
Campbell, CA | Oct 2011 - May 2014

Led typographic systems and interior/cover design for 50+ books annually using Adobe

InDesign and Illustrator. Coordinated with commercial print vendors and self-publishing platforms (including KDP and IngramSpark) to keep first-pass file acceptance high.

McDill Associates – Print Production Manager

Soquel, CA | Sep 2008 - Nov 2011

Designed packaging and managed print production workflows for national brands, including Costco, Martinelli's, and Rainbow Light. Built and verified packaging dielines, handled spot color separations, and coordinated with printers and paper suppliers for on-time retail rollouts.

West Marine – Prepress Manager

Watsonville, CA | Jan 2002 - Aug 2008

Designed, built, and optimized press-ready files for 800+ page national retail catalogs. Managed the prepress workflow, including preflighting, color management, and pagination/imposition layout. Managed print vendor relationships across years of high-volume seasonal deliveries.

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz – Coursework in Art, Design & Visual Studies